Governance Mnemonic Sheet

64 mnemonics from all five GS-2 Governance modules, in large type for the wall.

Teacher's and handout mnemonics are kept exactly as given. Mnemonics marked **own** were added where the material had none.

Last pages: cover-and-recall drills.

Module 1

Civil Services, Transparency, Accountability, Citizen's Charter, RTI

LADDER

Civil services: UPSC and SPSC
own mnemonic

Say it as a ladder: ***315 set up → 316 appoint → 317 remove → 319 bar → 320 functions → 321 extend → 322 expenses → 323 report*** *(order kept: it is the Constitution's order).*

UNDONE·A

Civil services: UPSC and SPSC
own mnemonic

UPSC's issues: ***U****nequal status ·* ***N****o qualification ·* ***D****eviation from advice ·* ***O****ne-size-fits-all ·* ***N****egative recruitment ·* ***E****xam structure ·* ***A****buse of 320(3)*

ACSM

Civil services: meaning and lateral entry
own mnemonic

A*ll India ·* ***C****entral ·* ***S****tate ·* ***M****unicipal (top to local)*

CORNERS

Civil services: meaning and lateral entry
own mnemonic

A closed system ***CORNERS*** *the officer:* ***C****onservative ·* ***O****bstacles to change ·* ***R****ule fetishism ·* ***N****on-responsive ·* ***E****litist ·* ***R****ank not competence ·* ***S****tatus quoist*

R R R R

All India Services
own mnemonic

Service Articles: ***309 Recruit · 310 Retain (pleasure) · 311 Remove (safeguards) · 312 Raise AIS****; then* ***16*** *equal opportunity,* ***323A*** *tribunals.*

I PANIC

Role of civil services in a democracy
own mnemonic

Six roles, no sequence (handout order N-C-A-I-P-I): ***I****mpersonality ·* ***P****rofessionality ·* ***A****nonymity ·* ***N****eutrality ·* ***I****nstrumentality ·* ***C****ommitment. A good officer never says "I PANIC".*

FIEA

Working and performance of civil services

own mnemonic

Four functions: **F**ormulate · **I**mplement · **E**valuate · **A**djudicate (and keep **continuity** when politics changes).

WILD SCARE

Working and performance of civil services

own mnemonic

Wage compression · **I**nterference · **L**ack of participation · **D**ual control · **S**treet-level corruption · **C**apacity · **A**rbitrary transfers · **R**eluctance to use protection · **E**valuation poor

SCORPIOS

Bureaucracy and development

own mnemonic

Bureaucracy as master stings: **S**ecrecy · **C**orruption · **O**ligarchy · **R**epresentation absent · **P**olitico-admin no-man's land · **I**nstrument→institution · **O**ppression · **S**uppresses NGOs

C R C C

Bureaucracy and development

own mnemonic

Development admin = **C**hange · **R**esults · **C**ommitment (time-bound) · **C**lients.

FORMULA

Pay, 8th CPC and right to strike

Revised Basic Pay = Existing Basic Pay × Fitment Factor · reference date **1 Jan 2026** · higher factor → higher allowances and pension liability.

HALO iOS

Civil services reforms and Nolan principles

own mnemonic

Nolan's seven: **H**onesty · **A**ccountability · **L**eadership · **O**penness · **I**ntegrity · **O**bjectivity · **S**elflessness. Handout order S-I-O-A-O-H-L.

CRAMPS

Challenges to reform; Karmayogi; Aarambh

own mnemonic

Communication · **R**esistance · **A**lignment with context · **M**anagement capacity · **P**olitical will · **S**afety nets

I C P S

Challenges to reform; Karmayogi; Aarambh

own mnemonic

*Karmayogi: **i**GOT · **C**ompetency · **P**erformance · **S**PV (+ the Commission).*

C C C

Challenges to reform; Karmayogi; Aarambh

***Aarambh** (Common Foundation Course): capacity-building initiative nurturing a **shared understanding of governance** among civil services probationers; stresses three foundational values for new entrants: **C**ommitment · **C**haracter · **C**onduct.*

TOP

Transparency and NDSAP

own mnemonic

*Three metaphors: **T**ool of good governance · **O**pen decision-making (secrecy vs privacy) · **P**ublic value (counters corruption).*

ACE TIPS

Transparency and NDSAP

own mnemonic

*Objectives: **A**ccountability · **C**ombat corruption · **E**ntitlements · **T**rust · **I**nformed citizens · **P**articipation · **S**ervice delivery*

EAR

Accountability

own mnemonic

*Components: **E**nforcement (sanctions for failure) · **A**nswerability (ability to justify an action) · **R**esponsiveness (responding to demands of the organisation and its clients).*

CHAI

Accountability

own mnemonic

*Dimensions: **C**ontrolling political power (prevent abuse via sanctions, transparency, duty to justify) · **H**uman (ethics, public values, trust in govt) · **A**rgumentative (citizens may seek explanations; authorities must justify conduct) · **I**nformational (citizens may receive information; institutions must give details).*

WHO CARE

Citizen's Charter and Sevottam

own mnemonic

ARC-II fixes: **W**idest possible consultation · **H**old officers accountable for results (penal provisions) · **O**ne size does not fit all (separate charter per unit and per service) · **C**ommit only to what you can deliver (fix timelines after assessing resources and workload) · **A**ppropriate redressal mechanism · **R**eform internal structures and processes to match charter commitments (obsolete rules, power distribution) · **E**valuate periodically with end-user feedback

D S D P M E I

Citizen's Charter and Sevottam

own mnemonic

Seven steps in order: **D**efine services · **S**et standards · **D**evelop capability · **P**erform · **M**onitor · **E**valuate impact · **I**mprove. Remember: Do Something Daily; People Must Expect Improvement.

MONOPOLY

RTI Act 2005 and the 2019 amendment

Monopoly + Discretion − Transparency = Corruption. Adding transparency through RTI checks corruption.

PAID

RTI Act 2005 and the 2019 amendment

own mnemonic

A sound regime: **P**enalties for denial (Rs 250 a day up to Rs 25,000, plus option of departmental disciplinary action) · **A**ccess wide (minimal fees, free for BPL, easily perceivable information) · **I**ndependent appeal (CIC, SIC) · **D**isclosure maximum, exemption minimal

16·120·100·5·10·20

RTI Act 2005 and the 2019 amendment

Publish **16** types of information within **120** days of the Act (update yearly) · designate PIOs in all units within **100** days · transfer a misdirected request within **5** days · third-party notice **10** days · exempt info released after **20** years. Reply **30 days**. Penalty **Rs 250/day, up to Rs 25,000**. Also: keep records catalogued, indexed, computerised; give as much info **suo motu** as possible to cut RTI requests.

1+10 · 3/65 · 5

CIC, RTI issues, impact and 2nd ARC

1 CIC + up to 10 ICs · term **3 years or age 65**, earlier one · no reappointment · IC elevated to CIC: total **max 5 years**.

BICEP

CIC, RTI issues, impact and 2nd ARC

own mnemonic

Without SC inquiry: **B**ankrupt · **I**nfirm · **C**onvicted (moral turpitude) · **E**mployed (paid) · **P**rejudicial financial interest.

Module 2

Corruption, Social Audit, CBI, CVC, Lokpal, Whistleblower, PCA

SPIES

Problem of Corruption

*Corruption **SPIES** on the nation: **S**ocial · **P**olitical and legal · **I**nternational · **E**conomic · **S**ecurity.*

APPLE

Problem of Corruption

*Corruption is the rotten **APPLE**; five kinds of factors rot it: **A**dministrative · **P**sycho-social · **P**olitical · **L**egal · **E**conomic.*

HORNETS

Problem of Corruption

*Psycho-social stings: **H**istory · **O**pportunity theory · **R**eligious context · **N**o popular sanction · **E**vils · **T**HYMOS · **S**quirrel Nuts Syndrome.*

CPI

Problem of Corruption

***CPI** by Transparency International · annual since **1995** · **0 = most corrupt, 100 = least corrupt**. 2020 CPI (released 2021): New Zealand and Denmark least corrupt; Somalia, South Sudan last; South Asia: Bhutan 24th; USA 25th, Botswana 35th, China 78th, Pakistan 124th (as printed).*

SCAR-I

Tackling Corruption and Social Audit

***S**tick (prosecution, stings, asset declaration) · **C**arrot (pay rise with enforcement, helplines) · **A**dministrative and technical (rotation, audit, procurement) · **R**adical (disband, gender balance, amnesty) · **I**nternational (FCPA, UK Bribery Act, OECD, UNCAC, FATF).*

MOST

Tackling Corruption and Social Audit

Social audit hurdles: ***M****ainstream policy discourse ignores it ·* ***O****pposition from vested interests ·* ***S****tatutory in very few programmes (NREGA) ·* ***T****rained auditors lacking.*

SCATTER

CBI and CVC

own mnemonic

S*ingle Directive struck down ·* ***C****VC superintends CBI on PCA cases ·* ***A****ppointment of Director by a committee ·* ***T****enure minimum 2 years ·* ***T****ransfer by the same committee ·* ***E****xecutive (DoPT) sets only the policy framework ·* ***R****eproach remains: still called a "caged parrot".*

1+2 · 4 · 65

CBI and CVC

1 Commissioner + up to 2 Vigilance Commissioners *·* *term* ***4 years*** *·* *age* ***65*** *·* *no reappointment.*

9 · 25 · 45 · 5/70

Lokpal in India

9 *members ·* ***25*** *years' experience ·* *min age* ***45*** *·* *term* ***5 years or 70****.*

COPES

Lokpal in India

Selection committee: ***C****JI or nominated SC judge ·* ***O****pposition leader (Lok Sabha) ·* ***P****M (Chair) ·* ***E****minent jurist (chosen by the four) ·* ***S****peaker of Lok Sabha.*

PAISE

Lokpal in India

Act covers the PM only partially: *the Lokpal shall not investigate a PM decision on "the Lokpal cannot count the PM's* ***PAISE****": Public order ·* ***A****tomic energy ·* ***I****nternal security ·* ***S****pace ·* ***E****xternal security and international relations. Even otherwise, the* ***full bench*** *must approve, by a* ***two-thirds majority****, the start of an inquiry or investigation against the PM.*

SAFE

Whistleblower Protection and PCA 1988

own mnemonic

Law Commission + 2nd ARC: ***S****trong law protecting genuine whistleblowers in* ***public and private*** *sectors (extend to corporate whistleblowers exposing fraud or serious harm to public interest) ·* ***A****nonymity and confidentiality ·* ***F****ear removed: legal protection against victimisation, administrative safeguards against harassment and bodily harm ·* ***E****ncouragement:* ***SEBI's tipping mechanism*** *pays up to* ***Rs 1 crore*** *for actionable information on insider trading and assures cooperation and confidentiality.*

BRIBE

Whistleblower Protection and PCA 1988

own mnemonic

B*ribe-giving an offence ·* ***R****eport within 7 days (coercive) ·* ***I****ncludes retired servants (17A) ·* ***B****usiness activities covered ·* ***E****xpedited trial: 2 years, up to 4 · jail term raised* ***from 3 to 7 years****.*

Module 3

Governance, E-Governance, Data Protection, Emerging Tech

SMART

Governance and Good Governance

Teacher's: **S**imple · **M**oral · **A**ccountable · **R**esponsive · **T**ransparent government.

PCR TARE

Governance and Good Governance

own mnemonic

UNDP eight: **P**articipation · **C**onsensus · **R**ule of law · **T**ransparency · **A**ccountability · **R**esponsiveness · **E**ffectiveness-efficiency · **E**quity-inclusiveness.

PLAES

Governance and Good Governance

own mnemonic

DARPG five: **P**olitical · **L**egal-judicial · **A**dministrative · **E**conomic · **S**ocial-environmental.

CCG LPC

People's participation and local self-government reforms

own mnemonic

Barriers: **C**aste · **C**lass · **G**ender · **L**ack of motivation · **P**olitical constraints · **C**apacity gap.

BCEI

E-governance: stages, models, benefits, issues

own mnemonic

Four models in handout order: **B**roadcasting · **C**ritical information flow · **E**-mobilisation · **I**nteractive service.

6 C's

E-governance: stages, models, benefits, issues

Teacher's **6 C's of work plan: C**ontent development (revise regularly, relevant to the zone) · **C**ompetence building (e.g. bank staff blame "server fault" and wait for an expert: give basic ICT training) · **C**onnectivity, esp. rural (else only the integrated part benefits, majority left on margins) · **C**itizen's interface (needs phone and internet; internet costly for rural people; awareness; accessible and affordable) · **C**yber laws (data protection and security; **technology-agnostic**; balance privacy so that productive use of technology is not compromised) · **C**apital (sites need revenue streams; reasonable charges, self-sustaining).

SLIPB

Data protection, privacy and cybersecurity
own mnemonic

Benefits: **S**ecurity (national) · **L**aw enforcement access · **I**ndia's own privacy rules apply · **P**rivacy grievance in Indian courts · **B**argaining power.

SHARP-DD

Data protection, privacy and cybersecurity
own mnemonic

Principles: **S**tructured enforcement · **H**olistic cover (private + govt) · **A**gnostic technology · **R**esponsible fiduciary · **P**urpose-limited minimisation · **D**eterrent penalties · **D**ata consent (informed).

Module 4

Civil Society, NGOs, SHGs, Pressure Groups, CAG

SAFE-SCAN

Civil society and NGOs
own mnemonic

Own anchor for significance: **S**upplement · **A**dvocacy · **F**reedoms defended · **E**valuate (audit) · **S**upport (technical) · **C**ontrol of state power · **A**ccountability · **N**ew leaders.

MM CESIE

Civil society and NGOs
own mnemonic

Roles: **M**ediatory · **M**obilising · **C**onsultative · **E**ducational · **S**upplementary · **I**nnovation · **E**fficiency (plus leadership, loopholes, accountability, informed dissent).

RCDM

Civil society and NGOs
own mnemonic

Generations in order: **R**elief · **C**ommunity · **D**evelopment-system · **M**ovement. (sequence kept)

PTAS-AD

FCRA, State regulation of NGOs, donors
own mnemonic

2020 changes: **P**ublic servants barred · **T**ransfer barred · **A**dmin cap 20% · **S**uspension 360 days · **A**adhaar · **D**esignated SBI account.

S-I-R-M-B

Self-Help Groups
own mnemonic

Teacher's **Panchsutra** (five regulars): **S**avings · **I**nternal lending · **R**epayment · **M**eetings · **B**ooks of account. (initials are my aid; the five points are the handout's)

SAIAA

Pressure groups and lobbying
own mnemonic

Five types: **S**ocial · **A**ssociational · **I**nstitutional · **A**d hoc · **A**nomie.

CARSE

Comptroller and Auditor General of India

own mnemonic

Audit-on: ***C****onsolidated and other funds ·* ***A****ccounts (trading, P&L) ·* ***R****eceipts ·* ***S****tores ·* ***E****ntities financed (bodies, PSUs).*

CFPP

Comptroller and Auditor General of India

own mnemonic

Four audits: ***C****ompliance ·* ***F****inancial ·* ***P****erformance ·* ***P****ropriety. The 1971 Act does not clearly state the types of audit;* ***Sec 23*** *authorises CAG to define the scope of audit.*

Module 5

Regulatory Bodies, FSSAI, CCI

GIFT PRICE

Regulatory bodies: why, role, courts
own mnemonic

Nine factors: **G**overnment was a player · **I**nvestment (FDI) · **F**air competition · **T**echnicality · **P**olitics insulated · **R**edistributive pressure insulated · **I**nterest of consumers · **C**onditions for growth · **E**xperience gap.

CAPE

Regulatory bodies: why, role, courts
own mnemonic

Why depoliticisation is limited: **C**apture by business · **A**utonomy limited · **P**olitical pressure · **E**quity (redistributive justice) duties.

PEDCT

Regulatory bodies: why, role, courts
own mnemonic

Contributions: **P**ublic participation · **E**lite capture checked · **D**emocratised space · **C**hanged political engagement · **T**ransparency.

3 QUALITIES

Regulators: people, ministry, accountability

Seek in a regulator: **Expertise** · **Independence** (not detachment) · **Ability to engage multiple players** (a miniature State).

UDLW

Regulators: people, ministry, accountability
own mnemonic

Staff woes: **U**nderstaffing 15-30% · **D**eputation dependence · **L**ow motivation · **W**eak ecosystem.

PAF PVCC

Regulators: people, ministry, accountability
own mnemonic

Ministry duties: **P**olicy · **A**ppointments · **F**unds and staff · **P**arliament interface · **V**igilance · **C**oordination · **C**apacity building.

RAPID SC

Regulators: people, ministry, accountability

own mnemonic

Accountability steps: **R**elationship defined · **A**ppointment transparency · **P**eriodic reports · **I**ndependent appeal · **D**ecision transparency · **S**tatute · **C**lear mandate.

CLIPS

FSSAI

own mnemonic

FSSAI functions: **C**onsumer protection · **L**abelling · **I**nspection · **L**icensing (registration) · **S**tandards. (rearranged: no fixed order)

DFSGR

Competition Commission of India (CCI)

own mnemonic

Amendment 2023: **D**eal value ₹2,000 cr · **F**aster 150 days · **S**ettlement and commitments · **G**lobal turnover penalty · **R**egulations 2024.

Cover-and-recall drill

Hide the right side. Say what each letter stands for, then check against the cards.

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C R C C	Bureaucracy and development
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HALO iOS	Civil services reforms and Nolan principles
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